How Ayushman Bharat Connects Healthcare

GS II

MAINS QUESTION 1

How does Ayushman Bharat combine financial protection and access to healthcare?

Ayushman Bharat connects financial protection with local healthcare, public facilities and digital records to improve patient access.

AB-PMJAY provides eligible families cashless hospitalisation cover, protecting savings from medical bills. Portability permits treatment at empanelled hospitals across states. Ayushman Arogya Mandirs offer primary care closer to home, reducing dependence on large hospitals for routine needs. PM-ABHIM strengthens critical care and disease surveillance. The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission allows consent-based sharing of health records between providers. These components serve needs without replacing one another.

Together, insurance, services, infrastructure and secure information sharing can make healthcare accessible and reduce financial hardship throughout care.

MAINS QUESTION 2

What administrative and digital safeguards are needed for reliable Ayushman Bharat services?

Reliable Ayushman Bharat services require coordinated administration, accountable hospitals and protection of patients' digital health information.

The National Health Authority establishes common standards, while State Health Agencies manage hospital empanelment and claims. Coordination supports implementation. Hospital payment packages need periodic updates for realistic costs. Poor payments can weaken service quality. Fraud checks, claims analysis help safeguard patients and public funds. Digital claims systems can improve transparency and processing, with supervision. Digital systems create privacy responsibilities. Patients should control the sharing of their records. Verified provider directories, shared medical terminology and connected records can help reduce fragmentation. ABHA supports digital health identification; it should not be confused with a promise of free hospital treatment. Services must also remain accessible to eligible patients seeking treatment across State borders. Expanded coverage for people aged 70 and above adds importance to dependable access. Governance must link national standards, local oversight and patient care.

Ayushman Bharat therefore needs both broader protection and stronger accountability. Effective coordination, realistic payments, trustworthy digital systems and consistent hospital services are essential to maintaining public confidence through effective public oversight.

PRACTICE MCQs (5)

1. An eligible patient seeks cashless hospital care outside the home State. What enables this?

A. Hospitalisation is restricted to the home State.
B. AB-PMJAY portability at empanelled hospitals.
C. ABHA replaces hospital insurance.
D. Primary care centres pay all hospital bills.
Correct Answer: B
Explanation: AB-PMJAY portability allows eligible patients to use empanelled hospitals across States.

2. What is required when digital health records are shared between providers?

A. Automatic sharing without patient knowledge.
B. Replacing treatment with an ABHA number.
C. Patient consent for record sharing.
D. Eliminating all provider verification.
Correct Answer: C
Explanation: The digital mission supports consent-based sharing of patient health records.

3. Which institution manages hospital empanelment and claims at the State level?

A. State Health Agencies.
B. Ayushman Arogya Mandirs.
C. National Solar Mission.
D. Individual patients.
Correct Answer: A
Explanation: State Health Agencies oversee empanelment and claims, while the National Health Authority sets common standards.

4. Which programme strengthens critical care and disease surveillance infrastructure?

A. ABHA.
B. Ayushman Vay Vandana.
C. Mission LiFE.
D. PM-ABHIM.
Correct Answer: D
Explanation: PM-ABHIM supports critical care facilities and public health surveillance infrastructure.

5. Who is covered by the Ayushman Vay Vandana provision described in the topic?

A. Only children.
B. People aged 70 and above regardless of income.
C. Only patients travelling abroad.
D. Only government employees.
Correct Answer: B
Explanation: The provision extends coverage to people aged 70 and above irrespective of income.

India's Path to Green Growth

GS III

MAINS QUESTION 1

How can clean energy and energy efficiency support India's green growth?

India's green growth depends on expanding clean energy and reducing energy waste alongside development.

Renewables can meet demand with less pollution. The National Solar Mission encourages solar power; PLI supports photovoltaic manufacturing. Energy efficiency complements cleaner supply by lowering demand in buildings. PAT addresses energy-intensive industries; building codes, Eco Niwas Samhita and efficient lighting improve energy use. Green hydrogen offers a pathway for reducing emissions in steel and fertiliser production. Developing these activities can also support jobs in manufacturing and transport.

Together, renewable power, efficient consumption and cleaner industrial technologies help connect economic opportunities with less pollution and resource efficiency.

MAINS QUESTION 2

What practical challenges must India address to make green growth resilient and inclusive?

green growth requires affordable technologies and practical planning and coordinated investment across industries, cities and communities.

Green hydrogen faces challenges of production cost, buyers, infrastructure and standards for use in steel and fertilisers. Renewable power and equipment manufacturing need investment. Efficiency measures must reach factories, buildings and homes. Water security requires treatment, reuse, efficient irrigation and groundwater recharge. A circular economy needs recovery facilities, markets for recycled materials and links with informal recyclers. Extended Producer Responsibility can support plastic and electronic-waste recovery through collection and processing. Cities need planning for transport, buildings, waste and water systems. Adaptation cannot be overlooked: early warnings and preparations for floods, heat and water shortages protect livelihoods and infrastructure. Financing links these goals to practical action. Governments, businesses and citizens need to coordinate investment, assess results and expand access. Mission LiFE adds an emphasis on responsible choices. These steps connect energy, resources and climate risks.

India's transformation therefore depends on linking clean technology with resource management, climate resilience, finance and participation. Success means environmental measures that work in everyday development and remain accessible to communities.

PRACTICE MCQs (5)

1. Which city plan best supports both development and climate resilience?

A. Build roads without improving water management.
B. Focus only on planting trees.
C. Combine transport, water management and infrastructure.
D. Ignore existing infrastructure and services.
Correct Answer: C
Explanation: Integrated transport, water and infrastructure address several urban pressures together.

2. Which approach best supports a circular economy?

A. Dispose of all discarded products.
B. Expand recycling and producer responsibility.
C. Increase raw-material use without monitoring waste.
D. Separate recycling from markets for recovered materials.
Correct Answer: B
Explanation: Recycling and producer responsibility help recover materials and keep them in productive use.

3. Which initiative targets energy-intensive industries through efficiency improvements?

A. PAT.
B. Ayushman Bharat.
C. ABHA.
D. Ayushman Vay Vandana.
Correct Answer: A
Explanation: PAT addresses energy use in energy-intensive industries.

4. What annual green hydrogen production target is described for 2030?

A. 1 million metric tonnes.
B. 2 million metric tonnes.
C. 10 million metric tonnes.
D. 5 million metric tonnes.
Correct Answer: D
Explanation: The National Green Hydrogen Mission targets 5 million metric tonnes annually by 2030.

5. Which combination best reflects the climate-adaptation measures discussed?

A. More waste disposal and less water monitoring.
B. Only additional fossil-fuel production.
C. Early warnings, resilient agriculture and water security.
D. Removing all urban green spaces.
Correct Answer: C
Explanation: Early-warning systems, resilient agriculture and water security are identified adaptation priorities.